Clout City: Hollywood Music — Clarifications & Updates (v1)

Oct 17, 2026 · @Internovatechnologies

This is the source of truth for Clout City: Hollywood Music's P1 game rules and scope. It is built from Clout City: NYC's Clarifications & Updates (v2): every rule there applies here unless this document changes it. Where another Hollywood Music document disagrees, this one wins, except for the World State layer, which follows the World State Layer Brief.

Related documents: Game Concept Note, World State Layer Brief, Story Quality Brief, Design System Guide, Milestones and Versions, New Features Spec.

Renames from Clout City: clout → **fame** (score); Queens → **Echo Flats** (starting neighborhood); boroughs → **districts**; club events → **club nights**; gigs → **brand deals**; Gigs app → **Deals app**. C$ (Clout Dollars) and Crew keep their names.

1. First-time experience and onboarding

The Clout City flow, with one changed creator step and a first show in place of the first party. Order: guest map → sign-up → creator (Look, Sound, Birth lottery, Home) → welcome → 5 tooltips → first task (open mic) → leaderboard → invite prompt → PWA prompt → story prompt.

#	Step	What changes from Clout City
1	Guest map	The illustrated Echo Flats map (section 3), with locked districts under clouds and the Halo Dome lit at the edge. First tap opens sign-up and starts the music
2	Sign-up	Unchanged: email or Google, 18+ checkbox
3a	Look	Unchanged: name field, presentation, body type, skin and hair, headwear then coverings, glasses and eyes, garments and colors. The eight starting styles move to the Sound step as scenes
3b	Sound	**New, replaces Traits.** Pick an instrument (Guitar or Keys in P1), one of eight starting scenes, and a band name (default: the player's name). The avatar now holds the instrument

#	Step	What changes from Clout City
3c	Birth lottery	Rolls starting cash between C$4,000 and C$8,000, plus one starter instrument (a beat-up model of the chosen instrument, cosmetic only)
3d	Home	Echo Flats rooms with weekly rent (section 3). Homes whose first rent would leave less than the phone bill are disabled
4	Welcome	New copy (below)
5 to 9	Tooltips	Fame (star), Money, Map, Phone, Shows (the mic icon). Tooltip 5 ends by tapping the Shows icon
10	First task: open mic	The Grind's open mic, always "happening now." Buttons: "Bring the crew" (invite a friend into the crowd, optional) and "Take the stage." The player plays the tutorial song (section 4)
11 to 14	Leaderboard, invite, PWA, hand-off	Unchanged in order and rules; the story prompt reads "Echo Flats has a mystery. Think you can crack it?"

Starting scenes (chips in the Sound step; each sets 3 to 4 starter clothing items and the treasure-hunt track, with no stats or bonuses): Garage Rocker, Bedroom Pop, Trap Hopeful, Indie Sadcore, Synthwave Kid, Country Crossover, Mall Punk, Afrobeats Dreamer.

The first open mic is protected and can't be failed. The tutorial song runs on Open Mic difficulty with coaching prompts; the Crowd meter can't empty during it. Every result pays first fans, fame and tips, and the completion card scales its joke to the score.

Starting cash rule. The minimum roll (C$4,000) always covers the cheapest room's first rent and the phone bill. The open mic is free.

Tutorial script

Welcome: Welcome to Hollywood. Every waiter here is in a band. Yours just has to be the one that makes it. Here's a quick tour before the industry eats you alive. [Let's go] · Skip tour (bold of you)

Tooltip 1: Fame: This is your fame: a scientific measure of how many strangers would ask for a selfie. Grow it by playing shows, being seen and owning things a real star would own. [Next]

Tooltip 2: Money: Your bank balance: rent, strings and the occasional bribe to a sound guy. The diamond is your net worth, aka everything you could sell if the band breaks up. [Next]

Tooltip 3: Map: This is Echo Flats. Every legend started somewhere cheap. The rest of town is locked until you're worth the drive. [Next]

Tooltip 4: Phone: Your phone. Gossip, brand deals, and your mom asking if this is "still the music thing." [Next]

Tooltip 5: Shows: Breaking news: the café's open mic has a slot. It's yours. Tap to take the stage.

Completion card (by stars): 1 to 2 stars: "Nine people clapped. Two were your crew. It counts." 3 stars: "Solid. A guy filmed it. Vertically." 4 to 5 stars: "The barista asked for your name. Not for the cup." Then "+N fans · +N fame · +C$N tips."

Leaderboard: "In this town, fame is the only ranking that counts. Here's where you stand." [Climb the charts]

2. Home screen and HUD

The Clout City layout carries over: a persistent top bar, a fixed right-side column, a collapsible stats panel and a four-tab nav. The changes are the fame icon, a Shows icon and a band button.

Top bar (persistent)

Side	Element	Icon	Shows	On tap
Left	Time	Text	City-clock time of day	None
Left	Daily Tasks	Checkmark + "0/5"	Today's tasks done	Opens Tasks on the Daily tab
Left	Sound	Speaker / slashed speaker	Music on or off	Toggles mute (remembered)
Right	Fame	Star + number (spotlight yellow)	The player's fame	Opens the fame leaderboard
Right	Net Worth	Diamond, no figure	—	Opens the Net Worth screen
Right	Bank Balance	"C$4,000"	Cash to spend	Opens transactions

Upper left, below the top bar

Unchanged: the **Invite your Crew** pill and the **Players Online** pill (hidden below the threshold, which starts at 1).

Right-side column (fixed)

Order	Element	Icon	Opens	Badge
1	Tasks/Goals	Checklist	Daily / Goals / Hunt	—
2	Shows	Microphone	Today's show slots at unlocked venues, plus club nights and events	When a slot opens or an event starts soon
3	Places	Building	The Places list	—
4	Band	Drumsticks	The band screen (section 5)	When Chemistry is low or band pay is due
5	Bills	Receipt	Bills and due dates	When a bill is due
6	Your Look	Person	The dressing room, now with an Instrument tab	—

The Shows icon replaces Clout City's Events champagne glass: events still live inside it, under the shows.

Bottom left: avatar bubble and stats panel

Unchanged from Clout City: a 56 pt avatar bubble opening the profile, and the collapsible Energy, Mood and Confidence panel with one suggested action per stat. Low Energy points to the cheapest open food; low Mood to a free boost (Lookout Park, a meal); low Confidence to practice or an open mic; high fans to the Deals app.

Profile adds **Fans**, **fame tier** (Nobody to Stadium Status), band name and members, instrument, best show (venue, song, stars) and setlist progress to Clout City's profile. Fame, rank, fans and net worth are public.

Bottom navigation: Home, Map, Phone, Shop (unchanged).

Notification pins: Net Worth and Invite your Crew on first play, as in Clout City, plus Band the first time a bandmate can be hired.

3. Map, Echo Flats and places

P1 has one compact, hand-illustrated 2D map of a fictional Hollywood. Every player lives in Echo Flats; the other districts are locked.

1. **One illustrated map (Lagos Life style).** The map is a single piece of art, not generated from real street data: a stylized town drawn slightly from above, with buildings as illustrated sprites, palm-lined roads, the hills with the CLOUTWOOD sign, and day and night versions. Echo Flats fits on about 1.5 phone screens at default zoom, with two zoom levels. It keeps Clout City's map interface (show pins, move the camera, locate the player, set a district's lock state), so districts can be added as new art and data without touching game logic.
2. **Locked districts** sit around Echo Flats under slow-drifting clouds with a 🔒 pill and "Coming soon": Starline Boulevard, Neon Row, Canyon Heights, the Studio Lot and the Pier District. Tapping one opens a sheet with its illustration and a one-line Lola teaser.
3. **The Halo Dome** is a map-flavor location at the far edge, always lit, with a pill reading "Stadium Status: locked." Its card shows the fame ladder and the player's place on it.
4. **The living map:** when zoomed in, a few decorative cars, a city bus and a light-rail train loop the roads, with headlights at night. Same caps as Clout City (about 30 on screen, paused when hidden, off under reduced motion).
5. **Place rules are unchanged:** location cards with illustration, lore and actions; visits cost cash and pay fame by price, once per real day per place; no spending before arriving; travel by distance band; story effects show a reason banner; no purchases at places except the monument postcard; invented names only.

Echo Flats: P1 places

Category	Place	Depth	Main actions
Homes	Laundromat Loft (studio, C$300/wk), Band House room (C$450/wk), Garage Bungalow (C$800/wk, own rehearsal space)	Full (apartment template)	Move in, practice, nap, sit, cook
Venues	The Grind (café open mic), The Rusty Amp (dive bar), The Basement (club), The Marquee (theater)	Full (stage template, section 4)	Play a show, watch a show, grab a drink or snack

Category	Place	Depth	Main actions
Music	Riff & Ruin (guitar shop, Musicians Wanted board, clerk job), Echo Room Studios (rehearsal rooms)	Full / scene card	Open Instruments and Gear in the Shop, hire bandmates, work a shift; rehearse with the band
Dining	El Cometa taco truck (budget), Starlite Diner (medium), The Grind (medium), Vantage rooftop (luxury)	Scene cards, The Grind full	Eat (Energy); fame once a day
Groceries	Fresh Flats Market	Scene card	Buy grocery bundles for the home fridge
Work	Hotel Valencia valet stand, Backlot 9 (film extras casting)	Scene cards	Work a shift
Outdoors	Lookout Park	Scene card	Hang out (Mood), busk (small tips, no fame)
Civic	Echo Flats Precinct	Scene card	Story actions only
Monuments	The CLOUTWOOD Sign lookout, The Wall of Almost (a mural of musicians who nearly made it)	Full (landmark plaza)	Pose for a photo, people-watch, chat with an NPC, postcard
Map flavor	Echo Flats Metro station, the Halo Dome, the locked districts	Label and lore	None

That's 19 visitable places. Rents and every price live in config.

Dining and Energy follow Clout City: the visit price is the meal, every meal restores Energy, the first visit each day pays fame by price. Venues sell a luxury-priced drink or snack (medium Energy, no fame). Groceries cooked at home are the budget option.

Names. All businesses, labels, radio stations and venues are invented. The CLOUTWOOD sign is original art and lettering, never the real hillside sign; no real Hollywood venue, theater, studio or star is named or drawn.

Daily tasks and goals

As in Clout City: five tasks a day, cash each plus an all-done bonus, reset at midnight New York time, shown as "0/5." The picker draws from shows at unlocked venues, visits, practice, band rehearsal and story tasks, and only picks places that are open and off cooldown. **Goals** are long-term ("Get 4 stars at The Rusty Amp," "Hire a drummer," "Reach Buzzing"). The Hunt tab hosts the weekly treasure hunt (section 14).

4. Shows: the performance game

A show is a roughly 2-minute rhythm game on a vertical note highway, played with thumbs. It borrows mechanics (not looks, names or songs) from Guitar Hero, DJ Hero and PaRappa the Rapper, and it's the only thing in the game that is pure skill. All numbers below are defaults in config.

4.1 Playing a show

1. **Slots.** Each unlocked venue offers one paid show per player per real New York day ("Tonight's slot"). The Grind's open mic is always open; the other venues open on the city clock (evening to late), with a countdown in real minutes before doors.
2. **Requirements:** the venue's fame tier (Concept Note section 4), enough Energy, and from The Basement up, at least two bandmates (section 5).
3. **Flow:** Go there → Play a show → pick a song from your setlist → soundcheck (audio loads) → 3, 2, 1 → play → results → rewards and share card.
4. **One retry.** If you're booed off, "the sound guy owes you one": one retry at that venue that day.
5. **Watching.** Every venue also has a free "Watch a show" visit action (normal visit rules: price, fame once a day, Mood).

4.2 Difficulty by venue

Difficulty	Venue	Lanes	Notes used	Max notes per second	Notes visible for
Open Mic	The Grind	3	Tap, hold	2	2.0 s
Bar	The Rusty Amp	4	Tap, hold, Hype	3.5	1.8 s
Club	The Basement	4	Plus chords and power strums	5	1.6 s
Theater	The Marquee	4	Plus crowd calls	6.5	1.4 s

Arena and Stadium difficulties come with those venues, after P1. Practice can use any difficulty the player has unlocked, plus a preview of the next one.

4.3 The highway and controls

- Lanes run top to bottom; notes slide down to a **hit line** about 22% up from the bottom edge. The tap zone for each lane is the full lane width below and just above the hit line, so thumbs never have to hit a small target.
- Each lane has its own color **and** shape (circle, diamond, square, triangle), so lanes read without color.
- Tapping an empty lane is never penalized; phone screens get mis-taps.
- Note speed (1× to 1.5×) and "big notes" are player settings. They change readability only, never scoring.

4.4 Note types

Note	How to play it	Where it appears	Inspired by
Tap	Tap as it crosses the hit line	All	Guitar Hero frets
Hold	Tap and keep your thumb down until the tail ends; bonus points while held	All	Sustains
Chord	Two lanes at once, both thumbs	Club, Theater	Chords
Power strum	Flick upward through the hit line in that lane	Club, Theater	DJ Hero scratches
Hype note	A glowing star-shaped note, in a short phrase; hit every one in the phrase to fill Hype	Bar and up	Star Power phrases
Crowd call	A call-and-response section (4.7)	Theater (Club in later songs)	PaRappa the Rapper

4.5 Timing, score and streaks

Grade	Window (either side)	Points	Crowd meter
Perfect	45 ms	100	+1.5
Great	90 ms	70	+1.5

Grade	Window (either side)	Points	Crowd meter
Good	135 ms	40	+0.5
Miss	beyond	0, streak resets	−4

- Holds add 10 points per beat held. Each note in a chord scores separately.
- **Streak multiplier:** ×2 at 10 notes, ×3 at 20, ×4 at 30. A miss resets it to ×1.
- **Callouts** pop over the highway: "Hot Start!" (first 25 notes clean), "50 Note Streak!" and every 50 after, "Hype Ready!", "Crowd's on its feet!"
- When a note is missed, the lead part of the song drops out briefly, so you hear the mistake (two audio stems per song: backing and lead).

4.6 Hype meter (the power move)

- Each completed Hype phrase adds 25%; fully held holds add a little.
- At 50% or more, the Hype button (a glowing pill beside the highway) lights up: "Hype Ready!"
- Tapping it starts Hype: the multiplier doubles (up to ×8), Crowd meter gains double, and the stage lights, highway glow and crowd go wild. It drains in about 8 seconds per 50%.
- Hype can't be bought, refilled or carried between shows.

4.7 Crowd calls (call and response)

In a crowd call, a bandmate or the crowd plays a short phrase (1 to 2 bars) and the player plays it back.

1. **Call:** the highway dims and a horizontal **call strip** slides in at the top, with the phrase's notes as lane icons on a timeline and a cursor sweeping across as the phrase plays.
2. **Response:** the cursor sweeps again and the player taps the same lanes in the same rhythm. The strip shows where each note should land, but no notes fall.
3. Each echoed note is graded like a normal note. A clean echo shows "They sang it back!" and adds 25% Hype. A live label rates the echo: Nailed it, Close, Off.

The same mechanic powers band rehearsal at Echo Room Studios (section 5).

4.8 Crowd meter (reading the room)

A meter beside the highway, starting at 60 out of 100, with a live label that changes as it moves:

Range	Label	Effect
80 to 100	Losing It	Lighters up; crowd sings along
50 to 79	Into It	Normal
25 to 49	Restless	Crowd chatter rises in the mix
0 to 24	Booing	The meter pulses red; boos in the mix

If it hits 0, the player is **booed off**: the song stops, the show pays 25% of the venue fee with no door share, fans or fame, Mood drops, and Lola delivers a one-line roast. At Open Mic difficulty, drains are halved and the crowd can't boo you off (open mic crowds are polite). The tutorial show can't fail at all.

4.9 Results and rewards

Stars come from the score as a share of the chart's base maximum (without Hype): 1 star for finishing, 2 stars from 40%, 3 from 60%, 4 from 75%, 5 from 90%. No misses earns a **Full Combo** badge. The results card shows stars, score, accuracy, best streak, crowd peak and a personal best per song and difficulty.

Reward	Rule (defaults)
Cash	Venue fee × star factor, plus door share. Fees: The Grind C$20 to C$60 in tips, The Rusty Amp C$150, The Basement C$400, The Marquee C$1,200. Star factor: 0.5, 0.75, 1.0, 1.25, 1.5
Door share	Turnout × ticket price × 20%. Turnout = 20% of capacity + 5% of the player's fans, capped at capacity
Fans	Capacity × 15% × star factor
Fame	Venue base fame × star factor × Mood and Confidence multipliers; Full Combo +20%. Paid once per venue per real day
Energy cost	The Grind 15, The Rusty Amp 20, The Basement 25, The Marquee 30
Confidence	+5 for 4 stars or more; −5 when booed off

Story effects can change a venue's availability or ticket price (cost only, per the World State brief) but never the timing windows, scoring, stars, fans or fame of a show.

4.10 Practice

Free, unlimited and available any time: at home on the practice amp or at Echo Room Studios. Any unlocked song, section looping and 75% speed. Practice pays nothing and costs no Energy, except that one practice session can count as a daily task.

4.11 Songs

P1 ships six original songs, each about 1:45 to 2:30 long and charted at all four P1 difficulties. Two are unlocked at the start; the rest unlock with fame tiers and goals.

#	Song	Feel	BPM	Unlocks
1	Open Mic Night (Be Nice)	Indie pop, tutorial song	92	Start
2	Rent's Due (Again)	Garage rock	128	Start
3	My Ex Started a Podcast	Synth-pop	110	Local Act
4	Echo Flats, 3 AM	Lo-fi R&B	84	Goal: 3 shows at The Rusty Amp
5	Opening Act Forever	Pop punk	150	Buzzing
6	Overnight Sensation (Ten Years Later)	Anthem rock	120	Headliner

Stories can add a limited-time **story song** (a diss track, a breakup ballad) through the World State layer; players who play it during its window keep it in their setlist.

4.12 Charts and audio

- **Chart data:** one file per song and difficulty: song id, BPM, audio offset, sections (Hype phrases, crowd calls) and notes (time in ms, lane, type, hold length). Songs and charts are data, so new songs are content, never code.
- **Validation:** notes per second within the difficulty's cap; at least 120 ms between notes in the same lane; holds at least 400 ms; no chords below Club; 2 to 4 Hype phrases per song; crowd calls only at Club and Theater.
- **Audio:** two compressed stems per song (backing and lead), fully loaded before the countdown.
- **Rights:** every song is commissioned with full rights (work for hire, including stems and edits) or licensed royalty-free with commercial, modification and stem rights. AI-generated music is used only if the tool's terms grant full commercial rights. No real songs, covers or sound-alikes of real artists.

4.13 Timing, devices and fairness

- **The audio clock is the master.** Note positions come from the Web Audio clock, never the frame timer, so lag never moves the notes.
- **Calibration:** after the tutorial show, the player taps along to 8 beats; the audio offset is saved per device. Settings has "Recalibrate."
- **Pausing:** leaving the tab pauses the song; it resumes with a 3, 2, 1. Pausing gives no advantage.
- **Performance:** at least 50 fps on a low-end Android phone; background stage animation drops first if frames slip; reduced motion turns off flashes.
- **Haptics:** an optional light buzz on Perfect where the browser supports it.
- **Fair play:** no item, purchase or story changes timing or scoring. The server rejects impossible results (a score above the chart's maximum, a show shorter than the song) and enforces one paid show per venue per day.

5. Band, bandmates and Chemistry

Players start solo and build a band of up to three NPC bandmates. Bandmates are a money sink, a venue requirement and the main source of personal drama.

1. **Hiring.** From Local Act on, the Musicians Wanted board at Riff & Ruin lists 3 to 4 candidates, refreshed weekly: one for each open role (drums, bass, keys or guitar, whichever the player doesn't play). Each has a name, a portrait, a one-line personality with a want and a flaw ("Dez: hits hard, shows up late, owes everyone money"), a weekly fee and a starting Chemistry. Hiring is a big-purchase confirmation.
2. **Weekly fee.** Band pay is a weekly bill beside rent, due on the same day. Fees scale with the bandmate's skill flavor, from C$80 to C$300 a week (config).
3. **Chemistry (0 to 100)** per bandmate, shown as a bar on the band screen.

Raises Chemistry	Lowers Chemistry
Rehearsing together (+8, once a day per bandmate)	Missing band pay (−20, then −5 a day)
Shows with 4 stars or more (+3)	Getting booed off (−6)
Paying on time for a full week (+2)	A week without a show or rehearsal (−5)
Story moments that favor them	Story moments that strain them

4. **Quitting.** When Chemistry falls below 20, the bandmate posts a warning ("Dez is 'taking some time to find himself'"). If it stays below 20 for 3 real days, they quit: the slot reopens, and Lola runs a small personal News item about the breakup. No items are lost.
5. **Firing.** Players can let a bandmate go from the band screen (destructive button, confirmed). It ends their fee and lowers every other bandmate's Chemistry by 3.
6. **Venue requirement.** The Basement and The Marquee need at least two bandmates. If a quit drops the band below that, those venues show "Need 2 bandmates" until the slot is filled.
7. **On stage.** Bandmates appear on the venue stage behind the player and are the "caller" in crowd calls. Chemistry never changes the player's score.
8. **Rehearsal (Echo Room Studios or the Garage Bungalow).** A short call-and-response mini-game (section 4.7): a bandmate plays a phrase, the player echoes it, five phrases per session. Costs 10 Energy and the room fee (free at the Bungalow); raises that bandmate's Chemistry by up to 8 by accuracy.
9. **Band screen.** Opened from the Band icon: band name (editable once a week), members with role, portrait, Chemistry bar, fee and "Rehearse," open slots with "Find a bandmate," and the band's best show.

After P1: friends as bandmates (player bands), bandmate stems that fill out each song as the band grows, and bandmates with their own story arcs.

6. Shop, Net Worth, selling and bills

Clout City section 5 applies unchanged (item listings, Net Worth screen, item values, 60% selling, diminishing returns on purchased fame, Your Look, no gifting, no buying C$), with these changes.

1. **Categories:** Fashion, Instruments, Gear (amps, pedals, mic stands, stage lights), Rides (a scooter, a used van for the band, cars), Homes and Luxury.
2. **Instruments and gear are cosmetic.** A new guitar or keyboard changes how the instrument looks in the player's hands, on stage and in Your Look (which gains an Instrument tab), and pays fame on purchase with diminishing returns like any item. No instrument or gear changes timing, scoring, Hype, the Crowd meter, fans or pay.
3. **The band van** (Rides) is fame flavor plus the "own car" travel option, as cars are in Clout City.
4. **Bills:** weekly rent, phone and **band pay** (section 5); ride rental and insurance when a ride is rented or bought. Missed rent follows Clout City's rules (3-day grace, Mood drop, after 7 days a move to the cheapest room, nothing lost).

5. **Net Worth values** follow Clout City: purchase price for C$ items, 1.5× the priciest C$ item in the category for real-cash collector items (which can't be sold), C$0 for starter items including the starter instrument.

7. Events and real-money purchases

Clout City section 6 applies, re-themed for music.

Event type	Paid with	Hollywood examples
Club nights	C$	Industry night at The Basement, a DJ set at Neon Row (locked), a showcase at The Marquee
Free story events	Free	A candlelight tribute, a fan protest outside a venue, a surprise pop-up show spawned by a beat
Exclusive events	Real money only ($3.99)	A pop star's listening party, an award-show afterparty, a legend's secret show

Exclusive events give keepsakes and recognition, not stats: an event card in the Collection ("Seen at Vexa Monroe's listening party"), a profile badge, a plus-one, and a News mention, exactly as in Clout City. Fame, Mood and Confidence match a comparable club night, with diminishing returns.

Real-money products (P1)

Product	Price	Promotion	Fame
Exclusive events	$3.99	Promoted first: the first real-money purchase players see	Diminishing returns
Story side arcs	$2.99 each	Promoted second, inside the story	None
Collector items	Set per item	Not promoted; a few rare instruments and stage outfits found while browsing	Diminishing returns
Monument postcards	$0.99 each	Offered once on the monument's card right after a visit	None

Payment rules are unchanged: hosted Stripe Checkout, one-time payments, the webhook is the only thing that grants access, `hasEntitlement(player, sku)` is the single gate, a refund revokes the item and takes back its exact fame, prices live in Stripe and config, and only these products show $ prices, the gold border and the ✨ REAL CASH tag.

Never sold, ever: C$, fans, fame, songs, venue unlocks, retries, continues, Hype, practice tools, bandmate Chemistry, or anything that changes a show's result.

8. Age, Energy, income, fame and travel

These rules close the loop: day jobs and shows earn cash, meals restore Energy, shows turn skill into fans and fame, and fans open brand deals.

Age and stats

- **18+,** confirmed at sign-up, as in Clout City.
- **Energy, Mood and Confidence** follow Clout City section 13: shows, visits, shifts, rehearsal and travel spend Energy; meals, venue snacks, napping, sitting, home cooking and the small midnight top-up restore it. At zero Energy players can read, vote, chat, shop, practice and pay bills, but can't play shows, visit, rehearse or work. Mood and Confidence multiply fame gains; Confidence drifts down a little each day.

Income

Source	What it pays	Notes
Shows	Venue fee, door share, fans, fame (section 4.9)	The main income once a player reaches Local Act
Daily tasks	Cash each, plus an all-done bonus	Unchanged
Day jobs	Cash per shift, no fame	Barista at The Grind, clerk at Riff & Ruin, valet at Hotel Valencia, film extra at Backlot 9. Limited only by Energy
Busking	Small tips, no fame	Lookout Park, once a day; a cheap Confidence boost
Brand deals	Big cash, no fame (below)	The Deals app

Brand deals (Clout City's gigs, re-themed)

Brand deals are rarer, bigger-paying jobs, gated by **fans** instead of Confidence, because brands pay for audiences.

Tier	Example	Fans needed	Offered	Pay (vs. one shift)	Energy (vs. one shift)	Wait
Session gig	"Play tambourine on a boy band's comeback single. Don't ask questions."	None	Most days	2 to 3×	1.5×	1 hour
Brand deal	"Write a six-second jingle for an oat-milk energy drink"	1,000	About every other day	4 to 6×	2×	2 hours
Big break	"Your song in the trailer for a streaming show about sad vampires"	10,000	Once or twice a week	10 to 15×	3×	4 hours

All Clout City gig rules apply: personal offers refresh and expire at New York midnight, one active deal at a time, Energy paid up front, cash when the wait ends, never bought or skipped with real money, invented brands and clients only, and stories can inject story deals.

Balance targets: day jobs plus daily tasks cover the cheapest room, the phone bill and budget meals with a small surplus; Rusty Amp shows plus session gigs cover one bandmate; Basement shows and brand deals fund a full band and a better room; a big break makes the Garage Bungalow or the band van reachable within weeks. Watch median bank balance and days to Buzzing in analytics; tune venue fees and deal multipliers first.

Fame

Unlike clout in Clout City, **fame unlocks venues** (the fame ladder in the Concept Note). Fame comes from shows, place visits, events, story tasks, correct predictions, invites, hunts and purchases (with diminishing returns). Fame never decreases, so a venue, once unlocked, stays unlocked. Fame tiers also appear as a title on the profile.

Travel

Unchanged from Clout City: no spending before arriving; "Go there" with walk, metro, rideshare or own ride, priced by simple distance bands; a skippable trip view; personal timers that never move the shared city clock. Echo Flats is compact, so most trips are short.

9. Story mode

Clout City section 9 applies unchanged in structure: one main story at a time, 6 to 10 beats, one per real day, a hidden truth solvable from free content, 2 to 3 predictions with live results and "Called It" badges, world hooks, three $2.99 side arcs per story, late-joiner catch-up, the archive and shadow guesses, all in the News app.

- **The pilot:** "Who Cancelled the Midnight Saints?", a 10-beat Echo Flats mystery about a band whose Marquee headline show is cancelled the night before a label signing. It's a lighter mystery than Sarah Bird: nobody dies.
- **Music hooks** stories can use on top of Clout City's (see the World State brief): cancel or add a show slot at a venue, add a limited-time story song, pack a venue with fans (ticket price up, with a reason banner), and inject story tasks such as "Play a show at The Rusty Amp the night the Saints play The Basement."
- **The pilot start** is set manually in the Story Studio when the player base is ready, on a Sunday.
- **Shop story items** work as in Clout City (a limited "Justice for the Saints" tour tee).

10. World State and the two clocks

The World State layer follows the World State Layer Brief and Clarifications section 12 of Clout City: one source of truth, story days on a server-authoritative New York clock, protected systems, cost-only price changes, the time-travel tool, the debug panel and the Story Studio.

Added protected systems: the tutorial open mic, show scoring (timing windows, points, stars, fans, fame), the Crowd meter, practice, and bandmate quitting. Stories can cancel or add a show slot but never change how a show is scored.

Two clocks, unchanged: the city clock (one day every 2 real hours, shown in the HUD) sets day and night, venue opening hours and show-slot times; the story calendar (real New York days) controls beats, predictions, resets, the one-paid-show-per-venue limit, fame cooldowns, chat limits, bills, band pay and the leaderboard. Anything that pays out follows the story calendar.

11. Chat

Unchanged from Clout City section 10: a Messages app, 10 messages per player per day, a word filter, block, report and the admin review queue (now in the Story Studio).

12. Sound and music

Two layers of audio, sharing the HUD speaker icon.

1. **Background music** on the map and in menus: original lo-fi and indie loops, starting on the first tap, mute remembered per player (as in Clout City).
2. **Show audio** in the performance game: song stems, crowd reactions (cheers, chatter, boos), and note feedback. The HUD mute applies to background music only; shows have their own volume in Settings, defaulting to on, because the performance game can't be played well in silence.
3. **Tracks:** original or properly licensed music only (section 4.12). No real songs.

13. Crushes and date nights

Clout City section 14 applies unchanged (mutual-only crushes, crush invites, date nights, safety, in-app notifications, gender-neutral copy), with one addition: **"Come to my show."** A date night can be set at a venue where the sender has today's slot; the bonus pays when the date has visited the venue ("Watch a show") and the sender has played there that day. The second story is a dating comedy, and Lola's dating column runs weekly.

14. Treasure hunts

Clout City section 15 applies (weekly, opt-in, Monday to Sunday, 4 to 5 steps with "Ask around," multiple-choice questions with a 10-minute retry, a finale, free hunt cards, cash and fame, a badge after four), with one track per **starting scene**:

Scene	Treasure
Garage Rocker	The first fuzz pedal ever sold in Echo Flats
Bedroom Pop	A lost cassette from a one-hit wonder
Trap Hopeful	A chain a legend left at Echo Room Studios
Indie Sadcore	A notebook of unreleased lyrics
Synthwave Kid	A prototype keytar
Country Crossover	A rhinestone guitar strap
Mall Punk	A signed skate deck from a band's first tour
Afrobeats Dreamer	A talking drum from a legendary session

All treasures and the musicians behind them are invented. From v0.4, a hunt step can be a short **riff challenge**: echo a 4-note phrase at Echo Room Studios (call-and-response, any accuracy above 60% passes; never a skill wall).

15. Tone, metrics and P1 scope

Tone. Satirical, funny and warm about the music industry: the open mic regular who's been "almost signed" for six years, the lawyer whose contracts have a Page 14, the influencer launching a singing career. Shop and activity copy leans in: "Vintage amp. Previous owner swears it was used by someone famous. Won't say who." No real artists, labels, venues or brands.

Success metrics. First show completed; crew invite sent; day-1 return of 35 to 40% (stretch 50%). Plus performance health (shows per day, finish versus booed-off rate, average stars by difficulty, practice sessions, drop-off per venue tier) and Clout City's story and money metrics.

P1 scope

- Guest entry, sign-up and the four-step creator (Look, Sound, Birth lottery, Home) with eight starting scenes and two instruments (Guitar, Keys).
- The welcome, five tooltips and the protected first open mic with the tutorial song.
- The illustrated Echo Flats map with 19 places, locked districts, the Halo Dome and the CLOUTWOOD sign.
- The performance game: four difficulties, six original songs, Hype, crowd calls, the Crowd meter, results, practice and calibration.
- Four venues gated by fame; fans; the band with Chemistry, rehearsal and quitting.
- The fame leaderboard, Shop (six categories), Net Worth, selling, bills (rent, phone, band pay), day jobs and brand deals.
- Club nights, free story events and exclusive events; the four real-money products through one Stripe Checkout flow.
- Invites and crew, chat, crushes and date nights, weekly treasure hunts, background music.
- The News app with "Who Cancelled the Midnight Saints?" and three side arcs, the World State layer, the Story Studio, the time-travel tool and debug panel.

Later

Other districts, the Echo Bowl and the Halo Dome; DJ, Vocals and Drums; recording and releasing singles with streaming royalties; tours; player bands and battle of the bands; song leaderboards; merch tables at venues; city news beyond stories (it arrives in v0.4

per the New Features Spec).

Open questions

- **Song production.** Partly decided: an AI music tool with full commercial rights makes songs 1 to 4, through the song pipeline (New Features Spec section 7). Still open: who makes songs 5 and 6 and the pilot's story song (AI or commissioned), decided before v0.4.
- **Instrument shown on stage.** The 3D avatar is posed and rendered to 2D sprites for the stage, or drawn as 2D art; decide in the v0.2 art test.